

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Area and volume	Hard

Question

The circumference of the base of a right circular cylinder is 20π meters, and the height of the cylinder is 6 meters. What is the volume, in cubic meters, of the cylinder?

Answer

- A. 60π
- B. 120π
- C. 600π
- D. $2,400\pi$

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. The volume, V , of a right circular cylinder is given by the formula $V = \pi r^2 h$, where r is the radius of the base of the cylinder and h is the height of the cylinder. It's given that a right circular cylinder has a height of 6 meters. Therefore, $h = 6$. It's also given that the right circular cylinder has a base with a circumference of 20π meters. The circumference, C , of a circle is given by $C = 2\pi r$, where r is the radius of the circle. Substituting 20π for C in the formula $C = 2\pi r$ yields $20\pi = 2\pi r$. Dividing each side of this equation by 2π yields $10 = r$. Substituting 10 for r and 6 for h in the formula $V = \pi r^2 h$ yields $V = \pi(10)^2(6)$, or $V = 600\pi$. Therefore, the volume, in cubic meters, of the cylinder is 600π .

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect. This is the lateral surface area, not the volume, of the cylinder.

Choice D is incorrect. This is the result of using the diameter, not the radius, for the value of r in the formula $V = \pi r^2 h$.